

Figure 2. Borrowing mechanisms from CHI'26 — inverting the rapport agenda

We reuse each paper's mechanism while reversing its goal: a critical-reflection tool must resist sycophancy and preserve critical distance.

CHI'26 anchors (goal: optimize rapport/liking)

Taheri (taheri26)

Mech: AI dialogue + critical friction
Self-reflection = serendipitous

Perspectra (perspectra26)

Mech: user-selectable expert agents
Goal: enhance critical thinking

RECALLbot (recallbot26)

Mech: agentic memory + reciprocal disclosure → deeper relationship

Hear You in Silence

Mech: context-aware pacing of guidance (hearinsilence26)

Vibe Check (vibecheck26)

Mech: personality/alignment tuning
Goal: maximize felt agreement

BORROW
+ INVERT

SafeBARS refinements (goal: critical distance)

① User-selectable experts

invite the lenses/roles to be challenged by
← Perspectra

② Agentic memory + reciprocal disclosure

recall prior commitments; state AI's limits
← RECALLbot

③ Context-aware pacing

pause after a self-discovery moment;
batch tensions by cognitive load ← Hear You in Silence

④ Alignment manipulation (RQ6)

critical/non-sycophantic vs sycophantic
← Vibe Check (goal inverted)

⑤ Critical friction, designed (RQ2)

ask, don't tell — realization owned by user
← Taheri (mechanism made deliberate)